

SUPER TEACHABLE PAPERS

(frege1948a?)

(russell1905a?)

(saul2012a?)

(saul2017?)

(evnine2026?)

SCHEDULE

Week	Dates	Topic	Reading
1	M 08/17 – W 08/19	Getting Started	Selection from Hobbes, Locke, Mill on names; Carroll, “Humpty Dumpty”; Swift, “Lagadonia”; Borges, “Analytical Language of John Wilkins”
2	M 08/24 – W 08/26	Sense and Reference	(frege1948a?)
3	M 08/31 – W 09/02	Definite Descriptions	(russell1905a?), (russell1919?)
4	M 09/07 – W 09/09	M: Labor Day W: Writing Day	5
M 09/14 – W 09/16	Proper Names	(kripke1980a?) (selections)	6
M 09/21 – W 09/23	Twin Earth	(putnam19?)	7
M 09/28 – W 09/30	Speech Acts	Austin	8
M 10/05 – W 10/07	M: Magical Incantations W: Writing Day	(evnine2026?)	9
M 10/12 – W 10/14	10	M 10/19 – W 10/21	11
M 10/26 – W 10/28	12	M 11/02 – W 11/04	M: W: Writing Day
13	M 11/09 – W 11/11	14	M 11/16 – W 11/18
Thanksgiving Break	M 11/23 – W 11/25	15	M 11/30 – W 12/02

Week	Dates	Topic	Reading
M: W: Writing Day	Finals	M 12/07 – F 12/12	Final Exam
• Strawson on Definite Descriptions • Kripke on Proper Names • Kaplan on Demonstratives • Grice on Conversational Implicature • Saul on Lying vs. Misleading • Austin on Speech Acts • Langton on Pornography			

SIDER'S SYLLABUS

Semantics

1/25 Martinich's introduction, sections I–VI; Mill, "Of Names"
 1/27 Frege, "On Sense and Nominatum" 2/1 Frege continued
 2/3 Russell, "On Denoting", and "Descriptions"
 2/8 Kripke, "Naming and Necessity" 2/10 Kripke continued
 2/15 Putnam, "Meaning and Reference" (may skip) (short paper due)
 2/17 Kripke, "A Puzzle about Belief"
 2/22 Quine, "Quantifiers and Propositional Attitudes" or Kaplan "Quantifying in"
 2/24 Kaplan, selections from "Demonstratives" (to be distributed) 3/1 Perry, "The Problem of the Essential Indexical"

Pragmatics

3/8 Austin, "Performative Utterances"
 3/10 Grice, "Logic and Conversation"
 3/24 Stalnaker, "Assertion"
 3/29 Lewis, "Scorekeeping in a Language Game" (to be distributed)

Foundations

4/5 Frege, "The Thought"
 4/7 Tarski, "The Semantic Conception of Truth..."; Davidson, "Truth and Meaning"
 4/12 [Something on deflationism?][Something by Dummett?][Hempel?]
 4/14 Grice, "Meaning"
 4/19 Lewis, "Languages and Language" (maybe skip)
 4/21 Quine, "Translation and Meaning"
 4/26 Davidson, "Belief and the Basis of Meaning"

4/28 Kripke, “On Rules and Private Language”

5/3 Millikan, “Truth Rules, Hoverflies, and the Kripke-Wittgenstein paradox”

SPEAKS ON MEANING

Jeff Speaks ((**speaks2021?**)) suggests a nice organization for (a large chunk of) the course:

1. Two Kinds of Theory of Meaning
2. Semantic Theories 2.1 Classical Semantic Theories 2.1.1 The theory of reference 2.1.2 Theories of reference vs. semantic theories 2.1.3 The relationship between content and reference 2.1.4 Character and content, context and circumstance 2.1.5 Possible worlds semantics 2.1.6 Russellian semantics 2.1.7 Fregean semantics 2.2 Alternatives to Classical Semantic Theories 2.2.1 Davidsonian semantics 2.2.2 Internalist semantics 2.2.3 Inferentialist semantics 2.2.4 Dynamic semantics 2.2.5 Expressivist semantics 2.3 General Questions Facing Semantic Theories 2.3.1 How much context-sensitivity? 2.3.2 How many indices? 2.3.3 What are propositions, anyway?
3. Foundational Theories of Meaning 3.1 Mentalist Theories 3.1.1 The Gricean program 3.1.2 Meaning, belief, and convention 3.1.3 Mental representation-based theories 3.2 Non-Mentalist Theories 3.2.1 Causal origin 3.2.2 Truth-maximization and the principle of charity 3.2.3 Reference magnetism 3.2.4 Regularities in use 3.2.5 Social norms

TENTATIVE STRUCTURE

THE SEMANTICS/PRAGMATICS DISTINCTION

Grice on Meaning and Conversational Implicature

Austin on Speech Acts

REFERENCE AND SINGULAR TERMS

Frege on Singular terms (**frege1948a?**)

Russell on Definite Descriptions and Logically Proper Names (**russell1905a?**)

Kripke on Proper Names (and modality) Naming and Necessity lectures 1 and 2

Perry on Indexicals (**perry1979b?**)

Kaplan on Demonstratives: no, this is too much.

Strawson on Definite Descriptions ((**strawson1950?**); also (**strawson1952?**))

Stalnaker on Presupposition (**stalnaker1973a?**)

Donnellan on Definite Descriptions (**donnellan1966a?**) (Also (**donnellan1968a?**))

Kripke on Speaker Reference vs Semantic Reference (**kripke1977?**)

(**abbott2019?**) offers a nice summary of the current state of the Kripke-Donnellan debate. Perhaps use it as the “textbook” here.

Lewis on Scorekeeping (**lewis1979e?**): this brings together several of the themes—incomplete descriptions, presupposition, but modality, vagueness, conversation—and sharpens the theoretical framework.

(**rosen2011?**): this applies several of the ideas covered earlier to the case of the interpretation of the law (**evnine2026?**) is a lovely little paper applying Austin to the case of magic.

(**ROSEN2011?**)

This is probably too difficult of a paper for the students. But it could work as one kind of capstone paper, showing the application of many of the ideas/frameworks/distinctions we have seen.

To use it that way, ideally, the students would have read (**grice1989?**), (**donnellan1966a?**), (**frege1948a?**), (**lewis1979e?**), (**austin1962?**), something by Bettcher on the meaning of ‘woman’, something by Wittgenstein on private language, something on demonstratives, maybe something on homophonic names.

Students reading this will need to know about speech acts and propositions.

- Law is made or unmade via speech acts.
- The law is a set of true propositions of the form, ‘According to the law of J, P’.
- Legal effect of a speech act modeled as a pair of sets: the propositions added and the propositions subtracted.

Cites Grice 1989 on meaning.

if textualism or intentionalism or any other determinate view of these matters is correct as an account of any part of the law—Bolivian criminal law, for example, or US constitutional law this will be thanks to special features of the relevant field of law and to contingent features of the legal regime in question. To a significant degree, the true principles connecting the linguistic features of legal utterances to their legal effects are a matter of positive legal fact, grounded in the legal history and practice of the community. The nature of law does not settle which of the many possible rules is in fact in place in the same sense in which it does not settle the details of the traffic code.

The talk of “changing the legal score” on p. 134: would be helpful for folks to have read (**lewis1979e?**)

the point about demonstratives and domain restrictions on p. 139 requires some background in those topics.

the point on p. 144 about homophonic proper names is a nice echo of the issue from Frege et al.

the case of Soper’s estate pairs with (**donnellan1966a?**) (who is explicitly cited, along with (**kripke1977?**), on p. 150)

The material on “personal meaning” would pair well with Wittgenstein on private language.

ugh. Example on p. 160: is a post-op transexual a wife... Could pair well with (**bettcher2013?**).

(**KRIPKE1977?**)

This presupposes N&N: the contrast between def descriptions and proper names; R on “logically proper names”; R on scope; de re/de dicto distinction in modal and attitude contexts; rigid/non-rigid def descriptions; doctrine that proper names are rigid;

How much does this presuppose N&N? Note the mention (p. 258) of Russell’s “logically proper names”, and the contrast between def descriptions and proper names...

the discussion of de dicto/de re, and “the number of planets is necessarily odd”—would be good to have prior exposure to this. Quine?

should definitely already know about scope, and R’s use of scope to distinguish de re/de dicto.

mentions Kaplan’s ‘dthat’ in passing (p. 260)

presupposes familiarity with speech act theory (p. 262)

When Kripke cites Grice, he cites:

“The Causal Theory of Perception,” “Logic and Conversation” (**grice1975a?**) “Meaning,” “Utterer’s Meaning, Sentence-Meaning and Word-Meaning,” (**grice1968?**) “Utterer’s Meaning and Intentions,” (**grice1969?**)

(LEWIS1979E?)
